

Elissa Coury

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EDUCATION

University of California, San Diego, La Jolla, CA

June 2027

Bachelor of Science in Cognitive Science, spec. Machine Learning and Neural Computation, Minor: Data Science

Relevant Coursework: Programming / Data Structures / Algorithms for Data Science, Theoretical Foundations of Data Science, Data Analysis and Inference, Practice of Data Science

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** Python, Java, R, HTML, CSS, MATLAB, SQL
- **Libraries:** Pandas, NumPy, statsmodels, scikit-learn, SciPy, seaborn, Matplotlib, Plotly, datetime, Requests, BeautifulSoup

PROJECTS

COVID-19 Text Analysis: Anti-Asian Language Trends

December 2025

Python, Jupyter, GitHub/git

- Led a team including novice Python users to analyze time-series COVID data and lexicon-based social media metrics, wrangling 500,000+ observations across 2 out of 3 datasets (Pandas, NumPy, Requests, datetime)
- Performed EDA with choropleth maps and correlation matrices showing Pearson's r values up to 0.77 (Matplotlib, Seaborn, Plotly) to explore relationships between COVID case trends and language patterns
- Applied NLP (TF-IDF) to measure spikes in anti-asian phrase uniqueness across 2020–2022 social media data (scikit-learn)

Behavioral Research Project: Cafe Culture

March 2025

Python, Pandas, Matplotlib

- Designed and executed observational study analyzing consumer behavior in public spaces, summarized into a 14-page paper
- Collected and coded real-time observational data across 10 behavioral/contextual variables and 30+ categories
- Generated summary tables and visualizations with Pandas and Matplotlib, identifying dominant patterns where ~80% of observations were young adults, feminine-presenting, and highly task-engaged across their respective variables

Image Processing Framework

May 2024

Python, Numpy, PIL

- Developed a modular image processing system to perform negate, grayscale, rotate, brightness, and blur
- Designed an RGBImage class for pixel-level representation, manipulation, deep copying, and error validation
- Implemented K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN) classification for image label prediction using pixel distances

Musician Data Analysis

November 2023

Python, Pandas, NumPy

- Cleaned and analyzed lyrics and audio features (danceability, tempo, etc.) from a major pop artist
- Built a Euclidean distance song recommendation tool and used TF-IDF to analyze lyrical importance and patterns
- Visualized song trends and relationships using Matplotlib

EXPERIENCE

Yalla, Let's Talk! @ UC San Diego, La Jolla, CA

Nov 2025 – Present

Secretary

- Maintain 90+ club documents and attendance records in G Suite and create monthly forms to track participation and support leadership decisions
- Assist with event planning and member engagement, contributing to 100+ attendees and expanding visibility across campus

Tokens Magazine, La Jolla, CA

October 2025 – Present

Promotions Staff, Website Development Staff

- Collaborate to create graphics for social media to increase engagement of over 1,500 followers
- Designing and developing a website to be shared with the upcoming Spring 2026 Zine issue (HTML, CSS, React.js)

Department of Cognitive Science, UC San Diego, La Jolla, CA

March 2025 – June 2025

Undergraduate Instructional Assistant

- Led instruction for a course section of about 60 students – presented content reviews during weekly discussions, facilitated interactive learning activities, and conducted exam reviews with the instructional team
- Assessed 50+ students' progress and grades of assignments and exams throughout the term
- Resulted in a final section grade average of 90.43%, ~1% higher than the course average